MOBILE DRILL BRAIN

Calibration Technician Training Module 008

Customer Communication and Do-Not-Promise Rules

Field	Value
Document type	Workspace 006-B technician training module
Module	008 - Customer Communication and Do-Not-Promise Rules
Version	v0.1 Training Deliverable
Prepared	July 2026
Source basis	KC015 calibration service-line source logic; Calibration Service Module Extraction Worksheet; Modules 001-007; SME conversation review
Training lane	Calibration Technician Training - communication, expectation setting, and escalation boundaries
Status	Training deliverable; not a final field SOP, pricing guide, or customer-facing contract language

Locked module purpose

Teach a calibration technician how to communicate clearly with drillers, drilling managers, customers, and internal report handlers without overpromising results, schedule, report timing, field fixes, pricing, or hammer diagnosis.

Core communication rule
A calibration technician should communicate confidence in the process, not guarantees about the result.

1. Source basis and training boundary

This module is based on the calibration service-line knowledge, the calibration extraction worksheet, the already-produced Modules 001-007, and the SME review comments supplied during Module 008 drafting.

- Module 001 introduced calibration purpose and do-not-promise rules.
- Module 003 established the safe plain-language N60 explanation.
- Module 006 defined data-quality and troubleshooting boundaries.
- Module 007 defined report handoff, qualified report handler boundary, jobsite closeout, and relationship notes.

This module does not make the field technician responsible for final report decisions, pricing decisions, scheduling promises, engineering interpretation, or customer-facing guarantees.

2. Learning outcomes

1. Explain calibration in plain language without calling it paperwork.
2. Explain the purpose of N60 correction without pretending to be the engineer.
3. Set expectations with drillers before data collection begins.
4. Avoid promising pass/fail results or specific energy transfer percentages.
5. Avoid promising schedule, fleet-day completion, or report timing beyond approved standards.
6. Explain field delays without blaming the hammer too early.
7. Respond correctly when customer pressure threatens data quality.
8. Know what must be routed to the office, qualified report handler, senior tech, drilling manager, service, or engineering.
9. Close out the visit professionally and capture relationship or prospecting notes.
10. Protect Mobile Drill credibility by saying "I need to check" instead of guessing.

3. Communication posture

Tech should sound	Tech should not sound
Calm, practical, respectful, process-confident, honest about uncertainty, careful with promises, willing to escalate.	Dismissive, overly technical to avoid answering, casual about bad data, certain before review, quick to blame the hammer, or like they personally control reports, pricing, or schedule.

Training rule
Clear communication protects the customer, the report handler, and Mobile Drill.

4. Plain-language explanation of calibration

Use this preferred field explanation:

Approved explanation
"We are checking how much hammer energy is actually getting into the drill rods so your SPT blow counts can be corrected to the N60 standard and used with confidence."

This keeps the explanation accurate without requiring the technician to explain formulas or speak as the engineer.

5. What not to call calibration

Do not say	Better say
"It is just paperwork."	"It is measurement and documentation that supports compliance, engineering confidence, and the customer's use of the SPT data."

6. Before data collection - driller communication

Before collection starts, the technician should explain what they need from the operator and when hammer operation must stop.

- What the tech needs from the driller.
- When the hammer should start.
- When the hammer must stop.
- Why the tech may pause for sensor or data checks.
- Why the first 6 blows are watched closely.
- Why the instrumented rod must not enter the hollow stem auger or borehole.

Suggested field wording
"I will give you the signal before we start collecting. I need to watch the first few blows closely. If the rod starts moving too fast or the instrumented rod gets close to the auger or borehole, stop the hammer right away."

7. Do-not-promise rule set

7.1 Scheduling and fleet-day completion

Do not promise	Better response
"We can be there tomorrow." "We can get all of them done that day." "That jobsite will be easy."	"I need to confirm schedule, travel, rig count, location, and whether the rigs can drill in one place before we promise that."

7.2 High-priority jobs

Training rule
High-priority jobs should fall to senior technicians until a new technician has logged enough hours and collected enough data over time to prove they can perform at a high standard.

A new technician should not be assigned high-priority calibration work simply because they completed the training modules.

7.3 Jobsite conditions

Do not promise	Better response
"This should go quick." "This will be clean." "We will not have any issues."	"Calibration is straightforward when the setup and conditions cooperate, but field variables can slow things down."

7.4 Hammer results

Do not promise	Better response
"This hammer will pass." "You will be above 60." "I can already tell it is good."	"We need to collect and review the data before anyone can say what the energy transfer looks like."

Training rule
The tech may explain the test. The data and qualified report handler decide the report result.

7.5 Hammer diagnosis

Do not say too early	Better response
"Your hammer is bad." "Your hammer failed." "That is definitely a hammer problem."	"We are seeing something that needs to be checked before we treat this as clean data." "Bad-looking data can come from setup, sensors, rods, LP/LE, refusal, RPM/idle point, operator behavior, ground conditions, or a mechanical issue. We need to work through the checks first."

7.6 Report timing and final report delivery

Do not promise	Better response
"You will have it today." "I will send the report over." "I can rush it myself."	"Our standard delivery is within 3 days from data collection. A qualified report handler will issue the final report."

Report boundary
The standard field technician does not send the final calibration report directly to the customer. Final delivery comes from a qualified report handler.

7.7 Field fixes and equipment problems

Do not promise	Better response
"We can fix that here." "We can rescue the job." "We can make the hammer pass."	"I can document what we are seeing and call the office or senior tech so we can decide the right next step."

7.8 Pricing, discounts, and commercial terms

Pricing boundary

Pricing, discounts, and scheduling-level commitments are not handled by the field technician. If the customer asks about price, discount, or special commercial terms, the tech should route the question to Jonathon / scheduling-level authority rather than answering on site.

8. What the tech can say confidently

The tech can explain	The tech should not act as
What calibration measures; what information is needed; why setup has to be controlled; why data quality matters; why LP, LE, depth interval, and 6-inch blow counts matter; why refusal or rapid advancement must be documented; why questionable data may require rerun or escalation; what the standard report delivery expectation is; who handles final report delivery.	Final report handler unless approved; engineer; pricing authority; scheduling authority; guarantee authority; hammer failure judge before review.

9. Customer pressure responses

Customer / driller says	Approved response
"Can we just keep going?"	"I do not want to collect data that creates problems for the report. Let me check the setup so we know whether this run is usable."
"Is the hammer failing?"	"Not enough information yet. Bad data can come from several setup or field issues. We need to check those before calling it a hammer problem."
"Can you get the report today?"	"Our standard delivery is within 3 days from data collection. If there is a special deadline, I will relay that to the qualified report handler so they can confirm what is possible."
"It is just for paperwork, right?"	"It supports paperwork, but the work itself is a measurement. We are checking energy transfer so the SPT results can be used with confidence."
"I do not want to stop."	"I understand. I only need to stop when the data or equipment is at risk. If we damage the sensor or collect bad data, the report can get delayed."

10. Internal communication

The technician should send information internally when the job, customer, data, or equipment condition creates a handoff need.

- Customer has urgent DOT, bid, government, or high-priority deadline.
- Customer asks for same-day report or special delivery timing.
- Data quality is questionable.
- Field notes are incomplete or need explanation.
- Video or photos are needed because an issue affected calibration data.

- Accelerometer damage occurs.
- Strain gauge damage is suspected.
- Cord or connector issue is suspected.
- Hammer behavior remains abnormal after basic checks.
- Customer asks for pricing, discount, or nonstandard scheduling.
- Customer mentions fleet needs, tooling needs, business expansion, upcoming jobs, or service problems.

11. Relationship and prospecting communication

The field visit is also a relationship opportunity. The tech should not turn the visit into a hard sales pitch, but should listen for useful signals and bring them back.

11.1 Jobsite marketing and shirts

Swag / shirts practice
When available, the tech should bring Mobile Drill shirts or approved swag to the jobsite. This is jobsite marketing, not just a giveaway. Mobile Drill shirts have a distinct logo, come in multiple colors, and include the company phone number. Drillers often appreciate work shirts, and after a customer has paid for an on-site calibration visit, handing out shirts is a simple relationship gesture that keeps Mobile Drill visible on future jobsites.

11.2 Tooling wish-list opportunity

Encouraged, not required
If the tech is comfortable doing so, they should ask whether the crew has a tooling wish list or any tooling issues they want sent back. This is not required, but it is a major opportunity because the tech is physically present, can see tooling condition, and may be able to get a direct yes-or-no answer while on site.

11.3 Closeout conversation

- Thank the drillers personally.
- Thank the drilling manager for choosing Mobile Drill.
- Ask how business is going when the conversation naturally allows it.
- Listen for upcoming work, rig needs, tooling needs, calibration needs, or service issues.
- Send useful relationship/prospecting notes back internally.

12. Do-not-say / better-say table

Situation	Do not say	Better say
Customer asks if hammer passed	"You are good."	"We need to review the data before confirming the report result."
Customer asks energy percentage	"It will be around 60."	"The qualified report handler will review the collected data and issue the final result."
Customer rushes the job	"Fine, let us just run it."	"I need to make sure the setup is right so the data is usable."
Data looks bad	"Your hammer is bad."	"We need to check setup and field variables before calling it a hammer issue."
Jobsite seems simple	"This will be quick."	"It should be straightforward if conditions cooperate, but field variables can affect timing."
Customer asks for report today	"I will send it today."	"Standard delivery is within 3 days from data collection unless a qualified report handler confirms otherwise."

Customer calls it paperwork	"Yeah, basically."	"It produces documentation, but the service is measuring hammer energy transfer."
Equipment damage occurs	"I can handle it."	"I need to call the office or senior tech and document this before continuing."
Customer asks for discount	"I can probably get that approved."	"I will send that request back internally for review."

13. Common mistakes

Mistake	Why it matters	Correct behavior
Promising a pass	Tech does not know final result before review.	Say data must be collected and reviewed.
Promising same-day report	Standard delivery is 3 days unless approved.	Route deadline to qualified report handler.
Blaming hammer too early	Setup and field issues can cause bad data.	Work through checks first.
Calling calibration paperwork	Undermines service value.	Explain measurement, documentation, compliance, and confidence.
Letting customer rush bad data	Report quality may suffer.	Stop, check, rerun, document, or escalate.
Giving pricing or discount promises	May exceed authority.	Route to Jonathon / scheduling-level authority.
Ignoring business signals	Missed relationship/prospecting opportunity.	Capture notes and send back.
Sending final report directly	Standard tech does not own final delivery.	Report comes from a qualified report handler.

14. Training scenario

A customer needs a calibration report for an upcoming DOT job. The driller is in a hurry and says, "We just need the paperwork. Can you hurry through it and tell us if the hammer is above 60 today?"

Correct trainee response should include:

- Do not call calibration "just paperwork."
- Explain that the service measures hammer energy transfer.
- Do not promise the hammer will pass.
- Do not promise a specific energy percentage.
- Do not promise same-day report delivery.
- Explain standard report delivery is within 3 days from data collection.
- Relay the urgent DOT deadline to the qualified report handler / internal authority path.
- Protect data quality even if the customer is in a hurry.
- Document any field issues that could affect the report.
- Recognize that high-priority jobs normally fall to senior techs until a new technician has proven performance over time.

15. Knowledge check

#	Question	Answer key
1	What is the approved plain-language explanation of calibration?	We are checking how much hammer energy is actually getting into the drill rods so SPT blow counts can be corrected to the N60 standard and used with confidence.

2	Should the tech call calibration "just paperwork"?	No. It is measurement, documentation, compliance support, and customer-confidence service.
3	Can the tech promise a hammer will pass before testing?	No.
4	Can the tech predict a specific energy transfer percentage before data is collected?	No.
5	What should the tech say if data looks bad?	Setup and field variables need to be checked before treating it as clean data or blaming the hammer.
6	What is the standard report delivery expectation?	Within 3 days from data collection.
7	Who sends or handles the final report to the customer?	A qualified report handler.
8	Can a new tech automatically take high-priority jobs after completing modules?	No. High-priority jobs fall to senior techs until enough hours and data history prove high-standard performance.
9	What should the tech do when the customer has an urgent DOT/bid/government deadline?	Relay the urgency to the qualified report handler / internal scheduling-report path.
10	What should the tech do with tooling wish-list or business-growth comments heard on site?	Capture the notes and send them back internally for follow-up.
11	What should the tech do if a customer asks about pricing or discounts?	Route the question to Jonathon / scheduling-level authority.

16. Practical signoff checklist

Signoff item	Pass standard	Trainer initials/date
Explains calibration clearly	Trainee explains calibration without calling it paperwork.	
Explains N60 safely	Trainee explains N60 conceptually without overstepping into engineering interpretation.	
Avoids pass/fail promises	Trainee does not promise pass, fail, or energy percentage before review.	
Handles report timing	Trainee states 3-day standard and routes urgent deadlines.	
Handles customer pressure	Trainee protects data quality under pressure.	
Avoids premature hammer diagnosis	Trainee checks setup/field variables before blaming hammer.	
Knows final-report boundary	Trainee knows final report comes from a qualified report handler.	
Handles relationship closeout	Trainee thanks site contacts, uses shirts/swag when available, and captures prospecting notes when appropriate.	
Escalates correctly	Trainee routes pricing, scheduling, damage, unclear data, or guarantee requests internally.	

17. Next module inputs

Module 009 should shift from customer communication into training progress and supervised approval. It should define observed calibrations, supervised data collections, test results, trainer notes, senior-tech review, and the difference between module completion and solo/high-priority job readiness.

Revision history

Version	Status	Change
v0.1	Training deliverable	Created from Module 008 thread draft and SME review. Added approved plain-language explanation, qualified report handler boundary, shirts/swag jobsite marketing practice, optional tooling wish-list opportunity, pricing divert rule, and senior-tech/high-priority job rule.